banks of a side-channel of the Cauvery, the Tellur, situated midway between Nagapattinam and Thiruvavur. They had been made by order of Raja Rajendra Chola and they recorded in a mixture of Sanskrit and Tamil various commitments involving land grants made by his late father Rajaraja Chola.



The royal seal of the Leiden Plates: twenty-four copper plates recording the terms of the funding of a Buddhist monastery by the Chola kings Rajaraja and his son Rajendra.

Using richly poetic imagery the king sets out at length the genealogy of his royal line and its many achievements. He then gives details of an order made by his father for the construction of a large Buddhist monastery, the *vihara* of Chulamanivarma at Nagapattinam, including its boundaries as determined by the circumambulation of a female elephant. The terms of the grant are set out in detail, including incomes to be derived from various surrounding